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Daily Current Affairs

Pakistan & the World

LEAD · PAKISTAN · POLITICS AND THE CONSTITUTION

Bilawal ties an end to KP governor's rule to the opposition's role in counter-terrorism policy

The Centre imposed the emergency on 11 October under Articles 232 and 234 of the Constitution. On 18 October the chairman of the PPP, which backs the move, said it could be lifted if the PTI-led opposition engages with the federal government on a common approach to terrorism.

TODAY AT A GLANCE

1 **KP governor's rule: Bilawal sets a condition for its end**
The PPP chairman says it could be withdrawn if the opposition agrees a counter-terrorism plan with the Centre.

2 **Military reports eight militants killed in three Balochistan operations**
ISPR also reports an army major killed in Gwadar; figures and attribution are the military's own.

3 **Iran says its seven-day Hormuz proposal stands**
Araghchi repeats the conditions; the Guards' report of another tanker hitting a mine is unverified.

4 **Egypt pledges support for Saudi Arabia**
The coalition reports two officers killed in a Najran helicopter crash; the Houthis claim a shootdown.

5 **Pakistan's first astronaut to fly from China on 25 November**
Planning Minister Ahsan Iqbal gave the date; the flight is scheduled, and the astronaut was not named.

Also in this issue: the Maldives president's state visit (20–22 October); Foreign Minister Dar's calls with Iran and Egypt; unrest and political reaction in France; Japan's scheduled Phobos sample-return launch. Items marked "scheduled" had not taken place by the cutoff. Every claim is attributed to the numbered sources in Section VI.

SECTION I

Pakistan current affairs

PAKISTAN · POLITICS AND THE CONSTITUTION

Bilawal says KP governor's rule could end if the opposition joins a counter-terrorism plan

The PPP chairman, whose party backs the emergency imposed on 11 October, set out his condition on the 19th anniversary of the Karsaz attack.

Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP) chairman Bilawal Bhutto-Zardari told reporters in Karachi on 18 October, during a visit to the Karsaz Monument, that the emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) could be withdrawn if the opposition, led by the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI), fights terrorism and agrees a plan with the federal government. He criticised KP Chief Minister Sohail Afridi, said his party was ready to fight militants itself, and called for a renewed National Action Plan and electoral reforms. He added that Governor Faisal Karim Kundi, a PPP nominee, now constitutionally represents the federation and that the PPP is not part of the federal government.

Background. The Centre imposed the emergency and governor's rule on 11 October. President Asif Ali Zardari approved it on the Prime Minister's advice under Articles 232 and 234 of the Constitution, the first dealing with a proclamation of emergency on account of war or internal disturbance and the second with the failure of constitutional machinery in a province. The government cited the provincial government's "deliberate disengagement" from the fight against terrorism; Parliament endorsed the step in a joint sitting amid opposition protests. Nawaz Sharif has said the decision should have come earlier, and the Prime Minister has said the Centre acted after a final attempt at agreement failed.

Why it matters. The statement matters less for what it changes than for what it reveals: a governing-coalition partner is describing the measure as security-driven and reversible, not open-ended. That framing puts the next move with the opposition, but the reports record no announced talks, so any early end to the rule remains a possibility, not a development. The episode also tests the federal–provincial balance. Under the rule, the governor, a federal appointee, exercises the powers that the elected provincial executive would normally hold, and Dawn describes the chief minister's role as non-functional.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Emergency imposed 11 October 2026 under Articles 232 (emergency) and 234 (failure of provincial constitutional machinery). 2. Bilawal's condition: opposition engagement with the Centre on counter-terrorism policy. 3. The governor acts as the federal representative while the rule lasts.

Sources **[5] [6] [7] [8]**

PAKISTAN · NATIONAL SECURITY

Military reports eight militants killed in three Balochistan operations

The army's media wing also reports an officer killed by a roadside bomb in Gwadar; all casualty figures and the "Indian-sponsored" attribution are the military's own.

The Inter-Services Public Relations (ISPR), the military's media wing, said on 18 October that security forces killed eight militants in three intelligence-based operations on 17 October in Balochistan. Five were killed in Quetta's Panjpai area after forces stopped an attempt to set up a roadblock; two died in a firefight at a hideout in Nushki; and one was killed in Khuzdar, where about 490 kilograms of explosives were recovered. ISPR described the group as "Fitna al-Hindustan", its label for militants it says India sponsors. Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif praised the forces, and ISPR said sanitisation operations were continuing in the areas concerned.

A separate ISPR release, reported on 19 October, said four militants were killed at Jattakabad in Kalat district on 18 October and that Major Wajahat Waheed, 34, of Lahore, was killed by an improvised explosive device while leading a clearance operation in Gwadar district. The report does not give the date of the Gwadar incident.

Background. Dawn, citing data from the Pakistan Institute for Conflict and Security Studies, describes Balochistan as the province most affected by terrorism and records attacks there rising 7 per cent, from 83 in July to 89 in August. The operations are described by ISPR as part of the Azm-e-Istehkam counter-terrorism campaign, which it says will continue.

Why it matters. The reports rest on a single institutional source, and the terrain makes independent confirmation difficult, so the tallies are best read as official claims. What they do show is the shape of the campaign: intelligence-led raids on hideouts, interdiction of attempts to block roads, and recovery of explosives in quantity. The death of a serving major in an explosive attack in coastal Gwadar, far from the central districts where most of Saturday's raids took place, indicates that the threat is not confined to one part of the province.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Quetta (Panjpai) 5, Nushki 2, Khuzdar 1; about 490 kg of explosives recovered (ISPR). 2. Campaign name: Azm-e-Istehkam; militants labelled "Fitna al-Hindustan" by ISPR. 3. Attribution and casualty figures are not independently verified in the reports.

Sources **[1] [2] [3] [4]**

PAKISTAN · SCIENCE AND FOREIGN RELATIONS

Pakistan's first astronaut to fly from China on 25 November, minister says

Planning Minister Ahsan Iqbal gave the date at a World Space Week ceremony; the reports do not name which of two selected pilots will fly. The flight is scheduled, not completed.

Planning Minister Ahsan Iqbal announced on 18 October that Pakistan's first astronaut will fly a mission from a Chinese space centre on 25 November, according to a planning ministry statement. He was speaking at the concluding ceremony of World Space Week in Narowal, held with the Space and Upper Atmosphere Research Commission (SUPARCO). The astronaut was not named. Dawn notes that China selected two pilots, Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud, as candidates in April, and that a SUPARCO official told Reuters the flyer would be a payload specialist running Pakistan's experiments rather than piloting the craft. Iqbal also said Pakistan aims for a lunar landing by 2035.

Background. Reuters reported on 28 September that the flight would make the selected pilot the first foreign astronaut aboard China's Tiangong space station and Pakistan's first crewed spaceflight. The stay would last about a week, aboard a Chinese spacecraft, with Chinese instructors and Mandarin communication. Chinese institutes chose four biotechnology experiments from more than 300 proposals, aimed at food insecurity and climate change. The mission was conceived by the two countries in 2019. In September a SUPARCO official said there was no official commitment or discussion about sending a Pakistani astronaut to the Moon; Iqbal's remark concerns a lunar landing, a separate and undated ambition.

Why it matters. The mission would give Pakistan a place in crewed spaceflight without an indigenous launch vehicle or crewed spacecraft, both of which Pakistan lacks. It is therefore best understood as an expression of the Pakistan–China partnership and of research capacity, in the form of experiments built and tested in SUPARCO laboratories, rather than of independent launch capability. Its significance for future programmes is untested: SUPARCO has said that next steps depend on how the first mission turns out.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Planned launch: 25 November 2026, from China, on a Chinese spacecraft. 2. Role: payload specialist, one of two candidates selected in April. 3. Would be the first foreign astronaut aboard Tiangong; Pakistan has no crewed launch capability of its own.

Sources **[9] [10]**

PAKISTAN · DIPLOMACY

Maldives president to make first state visit to Pakistan in 11 years

The Foreign Office announced the three-day visit, scheduled for 20–22 October, which coincides with the 60th anniversary of diplomatic relations.

The Foreign Office announced on 18 October that Maldivian President Mohamed Muizzu will make a state visit to Pakistan from 20 to 22 October at the invitation of Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif. He will be accompanied by First Lady Sajidha Mohamed and a delegation of ministers and senior officials. President Asif Ali Zardari will host a state banquet, and the Prime Minister will hold restricted and delegation-level talks. A Pakistan–Maldives Business Forum is planned, and the Foreign Office says several agreements and memoranda of understanding are expected to be signed, though none was named. Listed areas of cooperation include trade, health, education, defence, maritime security and climate change.

Background. Diplomatic relations were established in 1966. The last state visit by a Maldivian president to Pakistan was by Abdulla Yameen in May 2015, at the invitation of Nawaz Sharif.

Why it matters. The visit is scheduled, and its outcomes are unknown. The announced agenda is broad, with maritime security and climate change the points most relevant to two coastal and island-adjacent states, as The Nation observes. What can be said now is that the Foreign Office has framed the visit around the anniversary and an expected set of agreements; the content of those agreements will be the measure of its substance.

> **Key takeaways** 1. State visit: 20–22 October 2026; first by a Maldivian president in 11 years. 2. Diplomatic relations date from 1966 (60th anniversary).

Sources **[11] [12]**

PAKISTAN · FOREIGN POLICY

Dar speaks to Iranian and Egyptian counterparts as Gulf tensions mount

Pakistan's Foreign Office reports calls stressing dialogue with Iran and solidarity with Saudi Arabia against Houthi attacks.

Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar held telephone calls on 18 October with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi and Egyptian Foreign Minister Badr Abdelatty, according to Foreign Office statements reported by Dawn and The Nation. With Araghchi he stressed continued dialogue and diplomacy, and the two discussed the meeting of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) Council of Foreign Ministers in Baghdad. With Abdelatty he strongly condemned Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia and reaffirmed support for its sovereignty, territorial integrity and security. They also discussed the R-4 grouping of Pakistan, Egypt, Türkiye and Saudi Arabia and hoped to hold its next meeting soon.

Background. Islamabad hosted US–Iran talks on 12–13 April, which failed, and a memorandum to end the war was signed on 17 June; the ceasefire collapsed on 8 July, according to a Wikipedia timeline of the conflict.

Why it matters. The two calls reflect the position the Foreign Office has taken: engagement with Tehran and solidarity with Riyadh. The statements are expressions of intent, and the reports record no specific commitments. The grouping referred to is worth noting: the R-4 brings together Pakistan, which hosted the April US–Iran talks, with states that sit on different sides of the region's disputes.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Calls held on 18 October with Araghchi (Iran) and Abdelatty (Egypt). 2. R-4: Pakistan, Egypt, Türkiye, Saudi Arabia.

Sources **[13] [14] [17]**

SECTION II

International current affairs

WORLD · WEST ASIA AND ENERGY

Iran says its seven-day Hormuz proposal stands as the Guards report another tanker hit a mine

Foreign Minister Araghchi repeated the conditions in Baghdad; the Revolutionary Guards' account of the tanker incident has not been independently confirmed.

Speaking in Baghdad on 18 October, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said Iran's seven-day proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz remains on the table and that Washington has sent comments which Tehran is reviewing. He said Iran rejects US coercion, threats and intimidation. By his account, if the United States lifts its blockade of Iranian ports, removes sanctions on oil exports and ends hostilities on regional fronts, the strait could reopen within six days, with talks resuming the next day. Iran's new Defence Minister, Mehrdad Akhlaghi, said after a parliamentary confidence vote that a renewed US attack would cause enormous damage to Washington and its regional allies.

Separately, Dawn's live blog reported at 8:20 am PKT on 19 October that the Revolutionary Guards said an oil tanker caught fire after hitting a naval mine south of the strait, on what they called an unauthorised southern route with its navigation systems switched off. Al Jazeera had reported on 18 October, citing Iranian media, Guard claims that two tankers hit mines. The reports give no vessel names or casualty figures and do not confirm who laid any mine.

Background. US and Israeli strikes on Iran began on 28 February 2026. Iran blocked the strait in early March and requires ships to obtain its authorisation to pass; about one-fifth of global oil consumption passed through before the war. The United States maintains a naval counter-blockade on Iranian oil exports. Al Jazeera, citing Kpler data, reports that about 20.8 million barrels passed through on 8 October but only 2.9 million on 11 October.

Why it matters. Two things are being contested at once: the terms of a possible deal, and the rules of passage. Under Part III of the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, ships enjoy transit passage through straits used for international navigation and bordering states may not suspend it, so a demand for prior authorisation is a legal as well as a military question; whether those provisions bind particular states, or reflect customary law, is itself argued. The economic effect is already measurable: disruption to shipping has pushed up energy prices and inflation worldwide.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Iran's offer: reopen within six days if US lifts blockade and oil sanctions and hostilities end; talks on the seventh day. 2. Tanker and mine claims come from Iranian sources and are unverified. 3. Legal benchmark: UNCLOS Part III, transit passage (Articles 37–44).

Sources **[13] [16] [15] [17] [25]**

WORLD · ARABIAN PENINSULA

Egypt pledges support for Saudi Arabia as coalition reports two officers killed in Najran crash

The Houthis claim they shot down a Saudi helicopter; the Saudi-led coalition says it crashed because of a technical malfunction. The two accounts are unresolved.

The Saudi-led coalition said on 18 October that two officers were killed when an AH-6i reconnaissance helicopter of the Saudi National Guard crashed in the Najran region, which it blamed on a technical malfunction. Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree had claimed the group downed an Apache helicopter in the same area; Saudi officials

had not commented on that claim, and the reports do not reconcile the two accounts. Egypt's presidency said Cairo will provide Saudi Arabia with all necessary and possible support. President Abdel Fattah al-Sisi asked for an urgent parliamentary session to authorise military help if Riyadh requests it, and said any involvement would be strictly defensive. The reports do not give the outcome of the vote.

The coalition also said it intercepted two ballistic missiles fired at Khamis Mushait and several drones over the Riyadh area and the Eastern Province.

Background. After a four-year truce, fighting in Yemen resurged in July. Dawn reports that the Houthis seized strategic territory along the Red Sea coast last month, declared a maritime blockade of Saudi Arabia and have attacked Saudi targets including King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, where a strike a week earlier killed 13 people. The conflict dates to late 2014, when the Houthis seized Sanaa; a Saudi-led coalition intervened in 2015.

Why it matters. Egypt's step shows how a bilateral Saudi–Houthi war is acquiring a wider alignment, though no Egyptian military action had been reported. It also illustrates the domestic side of external assistance: Sisi said such action requires parliamentary approval. Pakistan has a direct factual link in the Dar–Abdelatty call, in which both condemned the Houthi attacks. Beyond that, the reports do not describe any Pakistani commitment.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Coalition: AH-6i crash in Najran, two officers killed, technical malfunction; Houthis claim an Apache shootdown. 2. Sisi: Egyptian help if requested, strictly defensive, subject to parliamentary approval.

Sources **[18] [19] [20]**

WORLD · EUROPE

France's government condemns violence after nationwide protests; Trump blames immigration

The protests took place on 17 October, before this issue's window; the government's condemnation and the US president's remarks were reported on 18 October.

French Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu condemned the destruction seen during nationwide protests and said the government would not be intimidated, blaming far-left criminals and warning against partisan exploitation of the unrest ahead of next year's presidential election, according to The News International. President Emmanuel Macron condemned the attacks and pledged to bring those responsible to justice. On 18 October, US President Donald Trump wrote on Truth Social that immigration had shattered France, which he said was burning. The News reports that he suggested France seal its borders. The article does not give an arrest figure; a sidebar headline cited more than 1,800 arrests, which this issue could not confirm.

Background. Authorities said 550,000 people protested nationwide on 17 October, including 110,000 in Paris, and the Interior Ministry reported at least 400 arrests, blaming the "ultra-left", according to Al Jazeera. The movement began in mid-September at a high school in Créteil over dilapidated buildings, overcrowded classrooms and teacher shortages, and widened to cover living costs and public services. Al Jazeera adds that French government borrowing costs are at their highest in more than 20 years.

Why it matters. The episode combines a domestic grievance, an unresolved fiscal constraint and, now, foreign commentary on a partner's internal politics. The French government has described the violence as the work of a minority; the reports record a largely peaceful march in Paris alongside clashes and looting elsewhere. The remarks by a US president on another state's domestic unrest are part of the diplomatic record, not evidence about the causes of the protests.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Protests: 17 October (550,000 nationwide per authorities); government and Trump responses reported 18 October. 2. Arrest figures differ across reports; the initial official figure was at least 400.

Sources **[21] [22]**

WORLD · SPACE · SCHEDULED

Japan prepares to launch a sample-return mission to Mars's moon Phobos

JAXA plans to launch the Martian Moons eXploration probe on Tuesday; the launch had not taken place by this issue's cutoff.

The Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA) is working to launch its Martian Moons eXploration (MMX) probe on an H3 rocket from the Tanegashima Space Centre on Tuesday at 4:41 am Japan time, which is 12:41 am PKT, Dawn reports. The reports do not state the calendar date; Tuesday after the 18 October reports is 20 October, after this issue's cutoff. If launched, the probe would reach the Mars region in August 2027, orbit Phobos for up to three years and collect at least 10 grams of surface material, delivering samples to Earth in 2031. A French–German rover, IDEFIX, is to make surface observations first.

Background. Dawn reports that China's Tianwen-3 mission is scheduled for about 2028 and could return Mars samples as early as 2031, and that NASA's Mars sample return effort was effectively cancelled after a January vote by the US Congress. JAXA says it hopes to establish whether Mars's moons formed from a giant impact or are captured asteroids.

Why it matters. A successful launch and return would be the first sample return from the Martian system. JAXA also says the mission will assess Phobos as a possible "natural space station" for future crewed exploration. Those outcomes are goals, and nothing in the reports confirms a launch.

> **Key takeaways** 1. Scheduled, not completed: H3 rocket, Tanegashima, planned for Tuesday. 2. Goal: at least 10 g from Phobos; return planned for 2031.

Sources **[23] [24]**

SECTION III

One-line general knowledge

Eighteen revision facts drawn from this issue's developments. Items marked "Background" are historical context, not news from the reporting window.

1. Under Article 38(2) of UNCLOS, transit passage is navigation and overflight exercised solely for continuous and expeditious transit through a strait. **[25]**
2. Article 44 of UNCLOS forbids states bordering a strait from hampering or suspending transit passage. **[25]**
3. Article 51 of the UN Charter preserves the inherent right of individual or collective self-defence if an armed attack occurs. **[26]**
4. Self-defence measures under Article 51 must be reported immediately to the UN Security Council. **[26]**
5. Background: Alexander George's Forceful Persuasion: Coercive Diplomacy as an Alternative to War was published by USIP Press in 1991. **[27]**
6. Background: securitisation theory is associated with Buzan, Wæver and de Wilde's Security: A New Framework for Analysis (1998). **[29]**
7. Article 232 of Pakistan's Constitution concerns proclamation of emergency on account of war, internal disturbance, etc. **[8]**
8. Article 234 of Pakistan's Constitution concerns failure of constitutional machinery in a province. **[8]**
9. The Centre imposed an emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa on 11 October 2026. **[6]**
10. KP Governor Faisal Karim Kundi was nominated by the PPP and constitutionally represents the federal government. **[5]**
11. Pakistan–Maldives diplomatic relations date from 1966; 2026 marks the 60th anniversary. **[11]**
12. R-4 is a grouping of Pakistan, Egypt, Türkiye and Saudi Arabia. **[13]**
13. Before the 2026 war, about one-fifth of global oil consumption passed through the Strait of Hormuz. **[15]**
14. The 2026 IMF–World Bank Annual Meetings were held in Bangkok, Thailand, from 12 to 17 October. **[30] [31]**
15. The State Bank of Pakistan says official reserves reached $21.5 billion by 9 October 2026. **[31]**
16. A Pakistani astronaut would be the first foreign astronaut aboard China's Tiangong space station. **[10]**
17. JAXA's MMX probe aims to collect at least 10 grams of surface material from Phobos. **[23]**
18. The Houthi–Saudi fighting resurged in July 2026 after a four-year truce. **[18]**

SECTION IV

Five essential terminologies of the day

TERM 1 · LEGAL PRINCIPLE · LAW OF THE SEA

Transit passage

Meaning. Transit passage is the freedom of navigation and overflight, exercised solely for continuous and expeditious transit, that the 1982 UN Convention on the Law of the Sea guarantees in straits used for international navigation between one part of the high seas or an exclusive economic zone and another. Bordering states may not hamper it or suspend it.

Why it matters. It is the legal baseline in disputes over maritime chokepoints. Part III also bars bordering states from suspending it (Article 44), which is why demands for prior authorisation are legally contested.

Current-affairs connection. Al Jazeera reports that Iran requires ships to obtain its authorisation before passing through Hormuz and that a Guards commander said vessels disabling their navigation systems would be treated as hostile. Whether Part III binds the states involved, or reflects customary law, is itself argued; the treaty text is the benchmark commentators use.

Source **[25] [15]**

TERM 2 · LEGAL PRINCIPLE · UN CHARTER, ARTICLE 51

Collective self-defence

Meaning. Collective self-defence is the inherent right, preserved in Article 51 of the UN Charter, of states to act together in response to an armed attack on a member. It lasts until the Security Council has taken the measures necessary to maintain peace, and states must report measures taken to the Council immediately.

Why it matters. Article 51 is the Charter provision invoked when states claim a lawful basis for armed assistance to a victim of attack. Whether a given action qualifies is tested against the Charter's conditions and is often disputed.

Current-affairs connection. President Sisi has said Egypt would act if Saudi Arabia requests help and that any involvement would be strictly defensive, with parliamentary approval as the domestic step. The reports do not say how Egypt would characterise any action in Charter terms; no Egyptian military action was reported.

Source **[26] [20]**

TERM 3 · THEORY · STRATEGIC STUDIES

Coercive diplomacy

Meaning. Coercive diplomacy is the effort to persuade an adversary to stop or undo an action by backing a demand with a credible threat of punishment, short of full-scale war. Alexander George treated it as a mix of threats, incentives, signalling and bargaining rather than force alone, and distinguished it from blackmail.

Why it matters. It explains how states seek to change behaviour at lower cost than war, and why the credibility of the threat and the adversary's perceived stakes decide whether it works.

Current-affairs connection. In the Hormuz dispute, Iran's proposal pairs reopening the strait with US concessions, while the United States maintains a blockade of Iranian ports and oil sanctions that Tehran wants lifted. Whether either side's conduct fits George's framework is an analytical judgement, not an established fact.

Source **[27] [16] [15]**

TERM 4 · ANALYTICAL LABEL · SECURITY STUDIES

Proxy war

Meaning. A proxy war is a conflict in which outside powers back one or more fighting groups, whether states or non-state actors, rather than fighting directly, in order to shape the outcome, advance their own strategic aims or weaken rivals. The support may be overt or covert.

Why it matters. The label signals external sponsorship, which bears on diplomacy, law and accountability. It is frequently contested: governments use it of their adversaries' backing, and accused states reject it.

Current-affairs connection. ISPR calls the militants killed in the Balochistan operations "Indian-sponsored". That is the military's attribution; the reports carry no independent verification or response from India, so here the term describes a claim, not an established finding.

Source **[28] [1]**

TERM 5 · THEORY · COPENHAGEN SCHOOL, SECURITY STUDIES

Securitisation

Meaning. In the Copenhagen School's theory, an issue becomes a security matter when an actor presents it as an existential threat to a valued object and an audience accepts that emergency measures beyond normal politics are justified. It is an analytical framework for studying how threats are constructed, not a legal doctrine.

Why it matters. It lets analysts separate a threat that exists from one that is successfully presented as such, and shows how emergency framing can widen executive power. The theory has its own critics.

Current-affairs connection. The Centre justified the KP emergency by citing the provincial government's disengagement from the fight against terrorism, and Parliament endorsed it amid opposition protests. Securitisation theory is one lens for analysing such framing; the formal legal basis is Articles 232 and 234 of the Constitution.

Source **[29] [7] [8]**

SECTION V

Daily current affairs MCQs

Fifteen questions: seven on Pakistan, eight international. Choose the single best answer. The answer key follows on the next page.

1. The Centre imposed an emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa on 11 October 2026 under which provisions of the Constitution?

A. Articles 58 and 112
B. Articles 232 and 234
C. Articles 245 and 246
D. Articles 184 and 187

2. Bilawal Bhutto-Zardari said KP's governor's rule could end if the opposition:

A. withdrew from the National Assembly committee on electoral reforms
B. agreed to fresh provincial elections
C. dissolved the provincial assembly
D. agreed with the Centre on a joint counter-terrorism approach

3. Planning Minister Ahsan Iqbal announced that Pakistan's first astronaut will fly a mission from China on:

A. 25 November 2026
B. 25 October 2026
C. 15 December 2026
D. 1 January 2027

4. The Pakistani astronaut is expected to fly in which role?

A. Mission commander
B. Spacecraft pilot
C. Payload specialist
D. Flight engineer

5. Which two pilots were selected in April as candidates for China's crewed programme from Pakistan?

A. Zeeshan Ali and Amer Gilani
B. Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud
C. Uzair Ansari and Khurram Daud
D. Amer Gilani and Uzair Ansari

6. ISPR said eight militants were killed on 17 October in three intelligence-based operations in which districts of Balochistan?

A. Quetta, Nushki and Khuzdar
B. Quetta, Kalat and Gwadar
C. Nushki, Washuk and Mastung
D. Khuzdar, Turbat and Panjgur

7. The visit of the Maldives president to Pakistan from 20 to 22 October is the first by a Maldivian president in how many years?

A. 5
B. 8
C. 20
D. 11

8. In the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, the definition of "transit passage" appears in which article?

A. Article 17
B. Article 87
C. Article 38
D. Article 121

9. Article 51 of the UN Charter preserves which right?

A. The permanent members' right of veto
B. The inherent right of individual or collective self-defence
C. The right to refuse the jurisdiction of the International Court of Justice
D. The right of peoples to self-determination

10. President Sisi said any Egyptian military involvement in support of Saudi Arabia would be strictly:

A. retaliatory
B. preventive
C. punitive
D. defensive

11. According to the Saudi-led coalition, what caused the crash of the AH-6i helicopter in Najran?

A. A technical malfunction
B. A Houthi missile strike
C. Friendly fire
D. A sandstorm

12. Which set of conditions did Iranian Foreign Minister Araghchi link to reopening the Strait of Hormuz within six days?

A. Withdrawal of Saudi forces from Yemen and a UN-run inspection of the Gulf coast
B. Recognition of Iranian sovereignty over the Gulf of Oman and a cut in oil output
C. Lifting the US blockade of Iranian ports, removing oil sanctions and ending hostilities on regional fronts
D. A new IAEA inspection regime and a Gulf maritime security pact

13. The Martian Moons eXploration (MMX) probe is designed to collect at least 10 grams of surface material from:

A. Phobos
B. Europa
C. Titan
D. Ceres

14. The 2026 IMF–World Bank Annual Meetings were held in:

A. Marrakech
B. Washington, D.C.
C. Singapore
D. Bangkok

15. In securitisation theory, a securitising move becomes a successful securitisation only when:

A. the UN Security Council approves it
B. the audience accepts the threat and the emergency response
C. a treaty authorising it is ratified
D. the legislature is dissolved

SECTION V · ANSWER KEY

Answer key

Q	Answer	Explanation	Source
1	B	Reports on Bilawal's statement cite Articles 232 and 234: emergency on account of war or internal disturbance, and failure of constitutional machinery in a province.	[6] [8]
2	D	He said the rule could be withdrawn if the PTI-led opposition fights terrorism and agrees a plan with the federal government.	[5] [6]
3	A	He gave 25 November as the date; the flight is scheduled, not completed.	[9]
4	C	A SUPARCO official told Reuters the flyer would run Pakistan's experiments rather than pilot the craft.	[9] [10]
5	B	Dawn names Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud; Gilani and Ansari are SUPARCO officials quoted by Reuters.	[9] [10]
6	A	Five were killed in Quetta, two in Nushki and one in Khuzdar, according to ISPR.	[1] [2]
7	D	The Foreign Office noted it is the first such visit in 11 years; the last was Abdulla Yameen's in May 2015.	[11] [12]
8	C	Article 38(2) defines transit passage; Article 37 sets the scope of straits used for international navigation.	[25]
9	B	Article 51 preserves the inherent right of individual or collective self-defence if an armed attack occurs, until the Security Council acts.	[26]
10	D	He said involvement would be strictly defensive and would require parliamentary approval.	[20]
11	A	The coalition blamed a technical malfunction; the Houthis claimed they shot down an Apache, and the accounts are unresolved.	[19] [18]
12	C	Araghchi named those three conditions, with talks to resume the day after reopening.	[13] [16]
13	A	MMX targets Phobos, a moon of Mars, with sample return planned for 2031; the launch was scheduled, not completed, by the cutoff.	[23] [24]
14	D	The SBP Governor and the IMF chief both spoke around the Bangkok meetings, held 12–17 October.	[30] [31]
15	B	Audience acceptance is the element that separates a securitising move from a successful securitisation.	[29]

SECTION VI

References and photograph credits

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